

Bet You Didn't Know

Shrink Or Expand Disks

Windows Vista comes with Disk Management, which even lets you shrink or expand volumes without destroying data on them. No need to buy expensive third-party utilities! Open the Control Panel, type in partition and press [Enter]. You will immediately see the link Create and format hard disk partitions under Administrative Tools. Click on it to launch Disk Management. Right-click on a partition and you will see the Shrink as well as Extend options. You should defrag the partition before doing the shrinking or expanding to achieve the best results, since the operation is dependant on the amount of contiguous free space available.

properties for more color options.) Click the Advanced button, select Border Padding in the Item dropdown field, and change the size from the default 4 to 0 (experiment with different values).

Take Ownership The Easy Way

Taking ownership of system files and folders in Vista is a pain. You can use the command line or the GUI, but you will tire after a while because there are simply too many steps. Here's a way that will add this option to the context menu, so all you need to do to take ownership is to right-click and select the option. Open Notepad and type in the following.

```
Windows Registry Editor Version 5.00
[HKEY_CLASSES_ROOT\*\shell\runas]
@="Take Ownership"
"NoWorkingDirectory"=""
```

```
[HKEY_CLASSES_ROOT\*\shell\runas\command]
@="cmd.exe /c takeown /f \"%1\" && icacls \"%1\" /grant administrators:F"
"IsolatedCommand"="cmd.exe /c takeown /f \"%1\" && icacls \"%1\" /grant administrators:F"
```

```
[HKEY_CLASSES_ROOT\Directory\shell\runas]
@="Take Ownership"
"NoWorkingDirectory"=""
```

```
[HKEY_CLASSES_ROOT\Directory\shell\runas\command]
@="cmd.exe /c takeown /f \"%1\" /r /d y && icacls \"%1\" /grant administrators:F /t"
"IsolatedCommand"="cmd.exe /c takeown /f \"%1\" /r /d y && icacls \"%1\" /grant administrators:F /t"
```

Save the file as takeown.reg. Double-click on the file and click Yes when prompted. There's no need to reboot.



Copying Over Mapped Drives

Vista has a known problem in which a mapped drive or network gets disconnected while copying large files. This is caused due to the new auto-tuning network, which changes the receive window on-the-fly. To turn this off, open an Administrative mode command prompt by running cmd.exe and pressing [Ctrl] + [Shift] + [Enter] or by right-clicking on the Command Prompt shortcut and selecting Run as Administrator. To turn Auto-Tuning off, type in netsh int tcp set global autotuninglevel=disabled



Assign A Hotkey To The Snipping Tool

Vista comes with a nifty screenshot utility called the Snipping Tool, which can capture all or parts of the screen. Problem is, the tool has no provision for a hotkey to bring up the window. In the Start Menu, click on All Programs and then the Accessories folder, and you'll see the Snipping Tool. Right-click on it and select Properties. You'll see an empty Shortcut key text box, in which you can place the mouse cursor and press a hotkey such as [Ctrl] + [F12].



Quick Launch Hotkeys

You can use hotkeys to launch the first 10 items in Vista's Quick Launch menu. These hotkeys are pre-assigned by Vista. To launch the first item, press [Windows] + [1], for the second, press [Windows] + [2], and so on.



From Deep Sleep To Shut Down

The default action of the Power Button in Vista is to Sleep, which is not really what everyone prefers. Just open the command prompt and type in powercfg.cpl,1 and press [Enter].



Bet You Didn't Know

Checkboxes To Select

You can use checkboxes to select multiple files. Click on the Organize menu and choose Folders and Search Options. Now on View tab, you will see Use check boxes to select items. Check the box against this and click OK. Using checkboxes to select files instead of doing the same by holding down [Shift] or [Ctrl] gives you better control and prevents accidental copying or moving of files. To select all files, simply check the box next to Name (above the list of names).



Bet You Didn't Know

Copy File Paths

You can copy the path of a file to the clipboard. Just right-click on the file while holding down [Shift] and you will find a new option in the context menu, "Copy as Path". You can also copy the path of a folder in this manner.



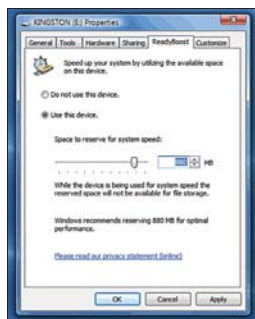
Enable Additional Clocks

There's an enhancement to the system clock in Vista which lets you display two additional clocks when you hover your mouse over the system tray clock (to keep track of time in a different time zone). To add a clock, right-click on the clock in the system tray and select Adjust Date/Time. Click the Additional Clocks tab, check the Show this clock box, select the new time zone, and give it a convenient name.



Speed Up Vista With ReadyBoost

Windows Vista comes with a new feature, ReadyBoost which lets you



Speed up Vista using ReadyBoost

plug in your flash drive or SD card to store commonly-used files for quicker access than from the hard drive. Just stick in the USB drive or SD card or any other Flash device.

In the

AutoPlay dialog that pops up, click the Speed up my system link, which takes you to the ReadyBoost configuration panel. Select Use this device, and set the amount of space you want to use. Windows will create a paging file of that size on the disk.



Add The Encrypt/Decrypt Option To The Context Menu

Vista has the option to encrypt and decrypt files by accessing the properties dialog. But there is a better and faster way to do it—just add these options to the context menu. Open the Registry editor and navigate to

```
HKEY_CURRENT_USER\Software\Microsoft\Windows\CurrentVersion\Explorer\Advanced
```

In the right pane, create a new 32-bit DWORD value called EncryptionContextMenu and give it a value of 1. Now whenever you right-click a file, you will see a new option, Encrypt, which will let you encrypt it (along with the parent folder, if